



Getting More Artists to Apply

A simpler way to spread the word about our open calls — and, for the first time, actually keep track of it.

[For the Not Real Art / Artsville team](#)

[Plain-English overview](#)

WHERE WE STAND

We're Great at Running Calls. The Word Doesn't Get Out.

What works

We pick a theme, open the call, choose the work, and put on a great show. We do this well, every time.

What doesn't

Telling artists the call is open. Today that's mostly one email to our own list — and not much else.

If only a small group hears about the call, only a small group applies. We're leaving the front door half-closed.

WHY IT MATTERS

More Artists Hear → More Artists Apply

The number of artists who apply is the single biggest thing we can grow.
And it touches almost everything we care about:

A stronger show

More applications means more great work to choose from.

A bigger community

Every artist who applies is someone new in our world.

A better story

"Hundreds applied from across the country" helps with grants and sponsors.

We already saw this work: when we paid to put a call in front of more people, a lot more people responded.

THE REALITY TODAY

Scattered, Slow, and Nobody Wrote It Down

Dozens of places

There are **60+ websites** where artists look for open calls — and most are free to post on.

All by hand

Posting is done one at a time, by whoever has a spare minute, a little differently each time.

No record

Ask "did we post the new call to that site?" — and nobody can say for sure.

So it's scattered, it's slow, and we can't see what got done. Good effort just disappears.

THE IDEA

One Simple Helper That Does the Busy-Work

What if one simple web page took the tedious part off your plate *and* remembered everything?

You tell it the **exhibition**. It looks up **everywhere we should post**, writes the **words for each place**, and keeps a **checklist of what's done**.

Think of it as a really good assistant who never forgets a step — not a robot that does it all without you.

HOW IT WOULD WORK

Five Simple Steps

- 1** Pick the exhibition. Paste the link to the open call.
- 2** It pulls in the details — title, deadline, description — automatically.
- 3** It hands you ready-to-use words for each place we post to — already worded to fit that site.
- 4** You post it, then tick it off. One click to copy, one click to open the site.
- 5** Anyone can look later and see exactly what was done.

YOUR SHORTLIST

Pick Your Go-To Places Once

There are dozens of places — you don't need all of them. **Star your favorite ten** once, and the helper focuses on those every time. No re-deciding for every call.

★ Your ten favorites

The places you trust and use. The helper shows these first, every single call.

The rest, still there

The full list stays available when you want it — but it's out of your way day to day.

Choose your go-to list once; it sticks — for everyone, on every call.

LET'S BE HONEST

It Won't Magically Fill Out Every Website

Most of these websites need a person to paste the words in and click "submit" — that's just how they're built. We're not promising a robot that does it all on its own.

What it does

Writes the words for you, hands them over ready to paste, opens the right page, and writes down that you did it.

What you still do

Paste and click submit. Seconds per site, instead of starting from a blank page each time.

Less robot, more **really good assistant**.

THE PAYOFF

For the First Time, We Can See Our Own Work

A real record

What we posted, where, and when — written down, in one place, for everyone.

No more guessing

We can finally tell what we did — and which places actually bring artists in.

Nothing slips

The checklist makes sure every call gets the full push, every time.

Same effort — but organized, shared, and remembered.

WHERE WE'D START

Try It on One Real Call

SMALL FIRST STEP

One call, start to finish

We pick the next open call (*The Art of Resistance*) and run it through the helper from start to finish.

WHAT WE LEARN

Did it make the day easier?

Did the call reach more artists? Was the work less of a chore? We find out before committing to more.

Small first step, real learning, no big commitment.

A COUPLE OF THINGS TO TALK ABOUT

Two Open Questions — Nothing Decided Yet

As we shape this, there are two questions for the team. Neither needs an answer today — they just help us decide what to build.

A helper of its own — or part of PolyWiz?

PolyWiz is the tool we already use to create and schedule our posts. Should this open-call helper be a **small, standalone tool** that does just this one job — or should it live **inside PolyWiz**? A separate tool keeps PolyWiz simple and focused; building it in keeps everything in one place.

Just for us — or for other art groups too?

Do we build this **only for ourselves** — or also as something we could one day **offer other galleries and art organizations**?

We can start small and decide both as we go — building it well keeps every door open.



Tell It the Exhibition. It Does the Rest.

It writes the words. You paste and tick the boxes. And — for the first time — we can look back and see exactly what we did to get more artists to apply.

Let's try it on one call.